June 23, 2026

Renee Walker
Thomas Jefferson University

Dear Renee,

The Board of Directors of the Academic Advisory Council for Signage Research and Education (AACSRE) is pleased to welcome you as a 2026-27 AACSRE Emerging Fellow and extend this notification of funding to you for your recent proposal. This award supports your proposed signage-related research with a $5,000 grant for the period from June 2026 through May 2027.

The financial award may be made to your university or directly to you, depending on your preference. AACSRE has set a maximum of 10% for indirect costs if a university administers the award. If the award is made directly to you, you will be required to submit IRS Form W-9.

Half of the financial award will be distributed upon completion of all initial documents and required actions to indicate award acceptance. The remaining half of the award will be distributed once the AACSRE Board determines that the proposed research project has been satisfactorily completed.

Emerging Fellows must agree to the following terms:

1. To acknowledge AACSRE for any publications and/or presentations that benefit from their financial award.
2. To submit a signage-related article to *Interdisciplinary Journal of Signage and Wayfinding* in 2026-27. More details about the journal can be found at: https://journals.shareok.org/ijsw
3. To present an AACSRE webinar about their signage-related research on a mutually suitable date in 2026-27.
4. To complete a 1 or 2-page report outlining their research progress by April 2027.
5. Attend quarterly Emerging Fellows check in zoom meetings. The first being Thursday, August 20 at 1pm Eastern.

To help you in achieving these objectives, we have established an AACSRE Mentor Program. Each Emerging Fellow has been assigned a mentor, who is an AACSRE board member with considerable expertise in signage research. Mentors will check in with Emerging Fellows throughout the year to ensure that they are making progress on their proposed research project, that their work is sufficiently signage-related, and that they are preparing to submit an article to IJSW and present their work in the AACSRE webinar series. Mentors will be assigned at the meeting on August 20.

Before we can process the first half of your financial award, we ask that you complete the following items no later than **July 13, 2026**:

1. Complete the AACSRE Emerging Fellow Marketing Info Form. In this Google form, you will need to upload your photo/biography and provide consent to having this information, as well as an abstract of your proposed research, appear on the AACSRE website, social media, and marketing materials.
2. Fill in the required information on the next page.
3. Accept the conditions of this fellowship by providing your signature and date on the next page.

Please feel free to contact me at 859.653.6503 or at execdir@aacsre.org. The board is excited to include you in our 2026-27 AACSRE Emerging Fellow class and looks forward to supporting you as you develop your exciting signage research.

Sincerely,

Maggie Mason
Executive Director

Please complete this page and email it back to Maggie Mason, execdir@aacsre.org

1. Emerging Fellow Award Acceptance

"I acknowledge and accept selection as an AACSRE 2026-27 Emerging Fellow 2026 Award, I agree to the terms discussed in this letter."

Renee Walker	Associate Professor, Thomas Jefferson University
Printed Name	Title and University Affiliation
Renee Walker	07/09/2026
Signature	Date

2. Award Payment (check one)

_____ I choose to have the award processed through my university. I acknowledge that AACSRE has set a maximum of 10% for in-direct costs if a university administers the award.

University contact for payment processing (skip if you choose to have the payment sent to you directly):

Name: _____

Email: _____

Phone: _____

__X__ I choose to receive the award directly and will complete the W9 Form (https://www.irs.gov/pub/irs-pdf/fw9.pdf) and email to execdir@aacsre.org.

Mailing address for direct processing (skip if you choose to have the payment sent to your university):

Name: Renee Walker

Address: 810 E Abington Avenue, Wyndmoor, PA 19038

Email: renee.walker@jefferson.edu

Phone: 503 407 8946